



HOW TO SELECT A **IT** PROVIDER

BUYING GUIDE

Know what to look for.

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Introduction

1.1 About Four Winds IT

We know that finding the right IT provider is crucial to achieving a secure, efficient, and growth-focused business. That's why our IT Buyer's Guide is designed to help potential clients understand what to look for in an IT partner, from service offerings to security standards. At Four Winds IT, we aim to educate businesses so they can make informed choices that align with their goals and ensure they select a provider who truly meets their needs.

1.2 Purpose and Scope

With this RFP, Gulf Coast Community Foundation (Gulf Coast), is requesting information about your company and the IT products and solutions provided by your company. Information will be gathered from several different organizations and used to evaluate provider options.

1.3 Confidentiality Statement

All information included in this RFP is considered confidential and intended only for use by responders. No information included in this document, or in discussions related to Gulf Coast's Managed Service Provider selection effort, may be disclosed to another party, or used for any other purpose without express written or verbal consent.



HOW TO SELECT A **IT** PROVIDER (Snapshot)

1

What is your approach to cybersecurity?

Ask how the provider secures networks, data, and devices, and if they offer proactive monitoring and threat detection.

2

How do you handle data backups and disaster recovery?

Inquire about their backup solutions, testing procedures, and how they ensure business continuity in case of system failure.

3

Can you scale your solutions to meet our future needs?

Understand how they plan for growth and scalability in terms of both technology and cost.

4

How do you support multi-factor authentication (MFA)?

Ensure the provider can implement and enforce MFA to enhance security across all user accounts.

5

What is your process for vendor management and third-party integrations?

Ask about their ability to manage other vendor relationships, such as hardware or software providers, and ensure seamless integration.

6

How do you ensure seamless communication and project management?

Find out how the provider manages projects, keeps you informed, and collaborates with your internal team.

7

What is your incident response and problem management process?

Inquire about their incident management procedures and how they handle and resolve issues swiftly.

8

Do you provide comprehensive reporting on system health and performance?

Ask if they offer regular reports on system uptime, health, and any issues, as well as provide clear insights for decision-making.

9

How do you manage software licenses and hardware inventory?

Confirm if the provider can oversee software renewals, manage hardware warranties, and keep track of all assets effectively.